MINUTES
OAKWOOD CITY COUNCIL WORK SESSION
JUNE 15, 2026

The Council of the City of Oakwood, Ohio, met in a work session on Monday, June 15, 2026, at the Long-Romspert Homestead/House Museum, 1947 Far Hills Avenue. The Mayor of the City, William Duncan, presided.

Council members present were Mayor William Duncan, Vice Mayor Steve Byington, Healy Jackson, and Sam Dorf. Council Member Leigh Turben was excused absent. Staff present were City Manager Katie Smiddy and Law Director Rob Jacques. Also attending for a portion of the meeting were Ann Febus, Karen Bartlett, and Andy Lloyd of the Oakwood Historical Society.

Mayor Duncan called the work session to order at 4:30 p.m. and began the meeting with a self-guided tour of the Long-Romspert Homestead/House Museum followed by a short presentation on the Society's current activities and challenges. Upon conclusion of the presentation, the Society representatives departed the meeting and Council remained with City staff to continue the work session.

Annual Report Draft Review
Mrs. Smiddy distributed an updated draft of the Annual Report and outlined a timeline for Council to provide additional comments and revisions.

MVRPC E-Bike Discussion
Mrs. Smiddy informed Council that she, along with Chief Hill and Mr. Jacques, will attend a Miami Valley Regional Planning Commission (MVRPC) discussion on e-bikes on Thursday.

School Renovation Planning
Mrs. Smiddy provided an update on the planning process for renovations to Smith and Harman Elementary Schools. Council discussed the advantages and disadvantages of several preliminary options currently under consideration.

Police Officers Memorial Fund Contribution
Mrs. Smiddy requested confirmation of the City's contribution to the Police Officers Memorial Fund. Council reached consensus to contribute $2,500.

Dayton Country Club Mowing Concerns
Mr. Jacques reported on resident concerns regarding mowing practices at the Dayton Country Club. The issue appears to have been resolved through an agreement with the City of Kettering regarding maintenance standards for naturalized areas on golf course properties.

20 Rubicon Road Lease Status
Mrs. Smiddy updated Council on the School Board's lease for 20 Rubicon Road, noting that the Board has not fully vacated the property. Council engaged in an extended discussion on the matter.

Old River Field Study Update
Mrs. Smiddy reported that a preliminary study of the Old River grass fields has been completed. Current usage levels may be unsustainable without significant investment. Discussions with the Oakwood United Soccer Association are ongoing, and the City is awaiting the final portion of the study, which will include recommendations and improvement options.

Budget Retreat Rescheduling
Mrs. Smiddy noted a scheduling conflict between the October budget retreat and the ICMA Conference. Council agreed to reschedule the retreat to November 5. The September 8 Budget Review Committee (BRC) meeting will be canceled as a result.

Personnel Update
Mrs. Smiddy reported that conditional job offers have been extended to candidates for the Parks & Recreation Foreman and Recreation Specialist positions.

Gardner Pool Swim Meet Schedule
Mrs. Jackson inquired about the Gardner Pool swim meet schedule. Mrs. Smiddy noted that the schedule is maintained and updated on the City website.

Longest Table Event
Mr. Dorf briefly commented on the recent "Longest Table" event hosted by the Oakwood Inclusion Coalition.

ODNR Grant Update
Mrs. Jackson asked about the status of the Ohio Department of Natural Resources (ODNR) grant awarded for park renovation projects. Mrs. Smiddy provided an update.

Council Attendance and Wellness Program
Mrs. Jackson noted she will be absent from the August 3 meeting. She also inquired about participation in the City's wellness program. Mrs. Smiddy reported strong participation and noted it may improve the City's position when seeking insurance consortium options during upcoming policy renewals.

Streetlight Banners and Hanging Baskets
Mrs. Jackson expressed support for the new Far Hills Avenue streetlight banners and asked about feedback regarding the hanging plant baskets. Mr. Dorf noted limited negative feedback, while Council overall expressed favorable views. Mrs. Smiddy stated that staff will continue to evaluate and refine planting approaches.

Mowing and Landscaping Contract Performance
Mayor Duncan requested an update on the performance of the City's mowing and landscaping contractors. Mrs. Smiddy provided an update.

Oakwood Historical Society Discussion
Vice Mayor Byington requested further discussion of challenges identified during a recent Oakwood Historical Society presentation. Council discussed the issues.

Former Indie West Building Activity
Mr. Dorf noted observed activity at the former Indie West building at the corner of Far Hills and Triangle Avenues and indicated a new business may be locating at the site.

Board of Health Membership Update
Mayor Duncan provided an update on the status of Board of Health membership.

Hollinger Tennis Center Agreement
Mr. Jacques updated Council on the Hollinger Tennis Center property agreement. The current 10-year agreement expires at the end of 2026, and Hollinger representatives have expressed interest in exercising the renewal option. Council discussed the organization's financial challenges.

The work session concluded at 7:10 p.m. and the meeting was adjourned.

William D Dow
Mayor

ATTEST:

Lori Upcraft
Clerk of Council